



TOKYO 1964 USHERED IN A GOLDEN PHASE FOR INDIAN HOCKEY

Gurbux Singh was part of the Indian side that won **two Olympic medals** — a gold at the 1964 Tokyo Games and a bronze at the 1968 Mexico Olympics.

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At 89, Gurbux Singh has seen India's hockey history evolve through the decades. He was part of the Indian side that won two Olympic medals — a gold at the 1964 Tokyo Games and a bronze at the 1968 Mexico Olympics.

His academic interests and strong moral code also led him to roles as a coach, selector, and administrator, with Gurbux dedicating over half a century to India's national sport.

Gurbux took up hockey at the age of 16 and quickly made his mark, representing Agra University in 1954–55. A year later, he clinched the Obaidullah Gold Cup, signalling the start of a promising career.

In 1957, he joined East Bengal, playing a pivotal role in its historic Beighton Cup victory. That same year, he signed with Calcutta Customs, where he played from 1958 to 1965. Later, from 1968 to 1980, he represented Mohun Bagan Club, further cementing his legacy in Indian hockey.

Gurbux represented Bengal in the Rangaswamy Cup from 1957 to 1972, captaining the side on numerous occasions. One of his standout achievements came in 1961 when he led Bengal to the prestigious Aga Khan Cup title.

His international debut came on June 5, 1961 during India's tour of New Zealand and Australia, marking the beginning of his glittering international career. He was part of the victorious squad at the International Hockey Tournament in Ahmedabad in 1962, followed by another successful outing in Lyon, France, in 1963.

His Olympic medals and Asian Games triumphs further solidified his legacy as a legend of the sport. In recognition of his contributions, he was awarded the Arjuna Award in 1966.

Even today, he remains a passionate supporter of the sport and its players. For his service to hockey and Indian sport, Singh was honoured with the Sportstar Aces Lifetime Achievement Award.

"I am thankful to The Hindu Group and Sportstar for honouring me at an event like this at the fag end of my career and my life. When I made my debut back in 1960s, there was a joke going around that wipers weren't invented to help me with my glasses in cold European conditions. I was the only player pursuing an Olympic sport with spectacles on. In our time, our job was to do hard work.

"The 1964 Tokyo Olympics, when we won back the gold medal, marked the beginning of a five-year second golden period for Indian hockey. I hope and pray that we can regain the glory we lost over the past 40 years and return to the right track, back to another golden age," Gurbux said.